

Executive AI governance report

AI-enabled recruitment screening

MANAGEMENT PURPOSE

A decision paper for leadership: should the AI screening tool go ahead, on what conditions, which risks need oversight, and what happens next.

Document detail	Value
Organisation	Gulf Professional Services PJSC (fictional)
Use case ID	AI-UC-001
Report ID	EXEC-001
Prepared for	Executive sponsor and AI governance forum
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Version and date	Version 1.0 17 September 2026
Assessment basis	Documents 1–5 and supporting risk-register workbook
Classification	Fictional case study (portfolio)

MANAGEMENT DECISION REQUIRED

Approve a controlled pilot only once the nine approval gates in Section 6 are evidenced. Do not approve production use at the current level of readiness.

All facts, ratings and recommendations in this report are fictional; it is a portfolio case study.

1. Executive summary

Gulf Professional Services wants to buy a third-party AI tool that reads job applications, compares them with role criteria and ranks candidates for recruiters. It would handle around 40,000 applications a year, with the aim of cutting first-stage screening time (now about 10 working days per role) and making prioritisation more consistent. It would not be allowed to hire or reject anyone on its own.

RECOMMENDATION: CONDITIONAL PILOT

Proceed only to a limited, controlled pilot, once the approval gates in Section 6 are met. Keep production unapproved until the pilot shows the safeguards work in practice.

Decision dashboard

Assessment area	Current position	Management implication
Use-case definition	Complete	Purpose, boundaries and stakeholders are documented.
Impact assessment	High potential impact	The tool affects who is considered for a job.
Risk position	12 risks: 3 Critical, 9 High before controls	Target is Medium or Low for all 12 after treatment.
Regulatory position	UAE data protection law applies; EU AI Act scope not yet confirmed	Qualified legal validation and provider evidence are required.
EU classification if applicable	High-risk (Annex III) if the Act applies	Plan for high-risk obligations from 2 December 2027 rather than assuming an exception.
AIMS readiness	Foundational	No AI policy, Statement of Applicability, internal audit or management review yet.
Launch status	Not approved for production	Controlled pilot only after mandatory gates are passed.

Leadership actions

- Appoint a named executive sponsor, AI Governance Lead and accountable risk owners.
- Confirm the legal entity, jurisdictions, provider/deployer roles, applicant locations, system output locations and data flows.
- Complete vendor due diligence and obtain system, data, performance, fairness, security, logging and change-management evidence.
- Approve the human-oversight model, candidate transparency and human-reconsideration process.
- Define acceptance thresholds and independently validate accuracy, job relevance, fairness, accessibility, robustness and security.
- Establish monitoring, incident, change, audit and management-review processes before production use.

2. Use case and assessment scope

Element	Executive description
Business problem	About 40,000 applications a year are screened by hand by a team of 12; first-stage screening takes about 10 working days per role.
Proposed AI use	Extract application information and rank or recommend candidates against approved job-related criteria.
Primary users	Recruiters; hiring managers see recommendations.
Affected people	External job applicants and employees applying for internal roles.
Decision boundary	AI provides decision support; an authorised human recruiter remains accountable for the final decision.
Deployment model	Third-party, cloud-hosted tool connected to the applicant-tracking system.
Geographic context	Initial UAE deployment; other applicant and output-use locations remain to be confirmed.
Scope exclusions	Autonomous rejection, emotion recognition, video analysis, employee monitoring and termination decisions.

3. Material findings

Finding	Why it matters	Required response
Fairness and inclusion	Data, feature choices, proxies or parsing may disadvantage groups or non-standard applicant histories.	Representative testing, feature review, subgroup analysis, accessibility review and approved remediation thresholds.
Accuracy and job relevance	Incorrect extraction or weak criteria may deprioritise qualified candidates.	Job analysis, benchmark validation, error analysis, correction workflow and independent review.
Human oversight	Formal human involvement may be ineffective if reviewers defer to ranking.	Competent, trained and authorised reviewers; challenge prompts, override and stop-use authority; decision records.
Privacy and data governance	CVs contain personal information and may reveal sensitive information.	Confirm applicable UAE regime, processing purpose, notice, minimisation, retention, correction, security and transfer controls.
Transparency and contestability	Applicants and reviewers may not understand the system or how to question it.	Candidate notice, limitations, reason information, correction, complaint and human reconsideration.
Third-party dependency	Provider design, data, model changes and subcontractors may alter risk without employer visibility.	Due diligence, contract terms, evidence rights, change notification, revalidation and exit plan.
Monitoring and change	Performance or subgroup outcomes may deteriorate after launch.	KPIs/KRIs, thresholds, drift review, complaint and override monitoring, reassessment and corrective action.

4. Risk position and treatment priorities

Priority risk theme	Inherent position	Target condition
Fairness and discriminatory ranking	Critical (score 20)	Validated fairness thresholds, remediation and ongoing subgroup monitoring.
Human oversight and automation bias	Critical (score 20)	Reviewers demonstrate informed challenge, override and stop-use capability.
Privacy and personal-data use	Critical (score 20)	Approved privacy assessment, minimisation, retention, access and vendor controls.
Accuracy and validity	High	Validated job relevance, extraction accuracy, performance and correction process.
Security and resilience	High	Security assessment, protected integrations, logging, incident and continuity arrangements.
Vendor and model change	High	Contractual evidence, version control, change notification and revalidation.
Governance and accountability	High	Approved RACI, governance forum, escalation and risk-acceptance authority.

RISK-ACCEPTANCE PRINCIPLE

A human making the final decision is not, by itself, a reason to accept a risk. Leadership should ask for evidence that the controls work in the live recruitment process.

5. Regulatory and standards position

Framework	Executive position	Required management response
UAE personal-data protection	Applies to applicant data. Onshore, the federal PDPL (Executive Regulations still pending); in the DIFC or ADGM, the free-zone data protection law.	Complete qualified privacy analysis and operationalise notices, rights, security, retention and transfers.

Framework	Executive position	Required management response
UAE responsible-AI context	The UAE Charter provides governance principles covering safety, bias, privacy, transparency, oversight and accountability.	Use these principles as governance design criteria and document how the system addresses them.
EU AI Act territorial scope	Not determinable from UAE headquarters alone; provider, deployer, establishment and output-use facts must be confirmed.	Obtain qualified legal validation before claiming applicability or non-applicability.
EU AI Act classification if applicable	Filtering and ranking candidates is an Annex III high-risk use. Obligations apply from 2 December 2027 under the Digital Omnibus, Regulation (EU) 2026/1744.	Plan for provider evidence and deployer controls appropriate to a high-risk system.
ISO/IEC 42001	Relevant voluntary management-system framework unless incorporated into another obligation or contract.	Use the AIMS mapping to establish policy, process, evidence, performance evaluation and improvement; do not claim certification.

6. Mandatory approval gates

Gate	Minimum evidence for pilot approval	Owner	Status
Purpose and scope	Approved intended use, prohibited uses, decision boundary and change triggers.	CHRO / AI Governance	Open
Legal and privacy	Applicability memo, privacy assessment, data flow, notice and rights process.	Legal / Privacy	Open
Provider and contracting	Due diligence, role allocation, system documentation, security and change/exit terms.	Procurement / Technology	Open
Data and fairness	Data specifications, relevance, representativeness, proxy review and subgroup test plan.	Data Owner / Model Risk	Open
Performance and validity	Job-related criteria, benchmark, accuracy/error thresholds and independent validation plan.	Analytics / Model Risk	Open
Human oversight	Approved SOP, trained reviewers, override, stop-use authority and decision records.	Recruitment Lead	Open
Transparency and redress	Candidate notice, correction, complaint and human-reconsideration route.	HR / Legal	Open
Security and resilience	Security assessment, access, logging, incident and continuity controls.	Information Security	Open
Monitoring and governance	KPIs/KRIs, thresholds, review cadence, escalation, governance forum and pilot decision record.	AI Governance Lead	Open

7. Implementation roadmap

Phase	Management objective	Key outputs
1. Confirm and govern	Set scope, accountability, regulatory facts and decision rights.	Approved scope, RACI, governance charter and applicability memo.
2. Evidence and design	Obtain provider evidence and design the required controls.	Vendor pack, control design, privacy/security assessments and test plans.

Phase	Management objective	Key outputs
3. Validate and pilot	Test performance, fairness, oversight and operating workflows under controlled conditions.	Independent validation, pilot results, issue log and remediation.
4. Decide and deploy	Accept residual risk only after gates and pilot exit criteria are met.	Formal go/no-go decision, training and production operating procedures.
5. Monitor and improve	Review outcomes, drift, overrides, complaints, incidents and changes.	Dashboard, management review, internal audit and corrective actions.

8. Governance and management reporting

Role	Executive responsibility
Executive sponsor / CHRO	Own the business outcome, approve purpose, ensure resources and make the final risk decision.
AI Governance forum	Challenge assessments, review evidence, approve gates and oversee incidents and material changes.
AI Governance Lead	Maintain inventory, coordinate impact/risk/regulatory/AIMS activities and report portfolio status.
Recruitment Lead	Operate meaningful human oversight, ensure reviewer competence and monitor decisions and overrides.
Legal and Privacy	Validate applicability, data governance, notices, rights and contractual safeguards.
Technology, Security and Procurement	Manage integration, supplier, security, logging, change, continuity and exit risks.
Model Risk / Independent Validation	Independently assess validity, accuracy, fairness, robustness and monitoring design.
Internal Audit	Provide independent review of AIMS and control operation according to the approved audit plan.

9. Management reporting indicators

Indicator category	What leadership sees
Performance	Extraction accuracy, ranking validity, error rates and failure modes against approved thresholds.
Fairness and inclusion	Subgroup outcome measures, accessibility issues and remediation status.
Human oversight	Override patterns, manual-review quality, stop-use events and reviewer training completion.
Applicant experience	Notices delivered, correction requests, complaints, reconsiderations and resolution timeliness.
Operational risk	Incidents, security events, provider changes, control exceptions and overdue actions.
Governance	Open high risks, approval-gate status, evidence completeness, audit findings and corrective actions.

10. Final decision statement

EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

Management should withhold production approval. A controlled pilot may proceed only after all mandatory pilot gates are evidenced and approved. Following the pilot, leadership should review validation results, unresolved findings and residual risks before making a documented production go/no-go decision.

11. Supporting portfolio artefacts

ID	Artefact	Purpose
01	AI Use Case Registration	Defines the organisation, purpose, system, stakeholders and boundaries.
02	AI Impact Assessment	Evaluates beneficial and adverse impacts on affected stakeholders.
03	AI Risk Register Report and Excel Workbook	Records risk events, causes, consequences, ratings, owners, treatments and evidence.
04	Regulatory Applicability Assessment	Evaluates UAE context and conditional EU AI Act scope and classification.
05	ISO/IEC 42001 AIMS Readiness and Control Mapping	Connects the use case to organisation-level governance, controls and evidence.
06	Executive AI Governance Report	Presents leadership findings, decision gates, roadmap and recommendation.

Sources and disclaimer

- EUR-Lex, consolidated Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 displayed 27 July 2026: <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/1689/2026-07-27/eng>
- Digital Omnibus on AI, Regulation (EU) 2026/1744 (in force 27 July 2026)
- European Commission AI Act Service Desk, Employment: <https://ai-act-service-desk.ec.europa.eu/en/employment-0>
- Official UAE Government Portal, Data protection laws: <https://u.ae/en/about-the-uae/digital-uae/data/data-protection-laws>
- Official UAE Government Portal, UAE Charter for the Development and Use of Artificial Intelligence: <https://u.ae/en/about-the-uae/strategies-initiatives-and-awards/policies/Ai/The-UAE-Charter-for-the-Development-and-Use-of-Artificial-Intelligence>
- ISO, ISO/IEC 42001:2023 overview: <https://www.iso.org/standard/42001>

Fictional case study prepared for my AI governance portfolio. It is not legal advice, an audit, an ISO certification decision or a production approval, and it reflects the law as at September 2026.